

Fares Amari

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Solutions Engineering Leader | Pre-Sales & Technical Strategy | AI & Cloud Architecture

Technical sales leader with 10+ years directing pre-sales engineering, AI and cloud solution design, and enterprise-wide proof-of-concept initiatives at Microsoft and SHI. Served as enterprise technical lead for all major pursuits, coordinating 10+ dotted-line Solutions Engineers and Services Engineers across complex, multi-stakeholder deals. Proven people leader with a track record of mentoring and building high-performing technical teams. Expertise in leading technical and business workshops, architecting POC environments, translating business requirements into scalable solutions, and partnering with sales to accelerate pipeline and close. Industry experience spans healthcare, utilities, oil and gas, manufacturing, higher education, and retail.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Solutions Engineering Leadership | Pre-Sales Strategy | POC Design & Execution | Technical Workshops | Team Mentoring
Cloud & AI Architecture | RFP/RFI Response | Cross-Functional Collaboration | Pipeline Acceleration | SE Enablement | C-Suite Engagement

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Microsoft, Redmond, Washington - June 2022 – October 2025

Account Technology Strategist

- Served as enterprise technical lead across all major pursuits, coordinating 10+ dotted-line Solutions Engineers and Services Engineers to drive 200% pipeline growth and 15% YoY cloud expansion through technically differentiated proposals and solution designs.
- Architected and led AI/Copilot proof-of-concept initiatives for enterprise customers, designing end-to-end POC environments, defining success criteria, and presenting outcomes to C-suite stakeholders to accelerate technical validation and deal progression.
- Founded and led a structured mentoring ring for 11-15 Microsoft technologists, fostering a culture of curiosity, humility, and growth — resulting in promotions for more than 50% of participants within their first year.
- Designed and facilitated technical and business workshops for C-suite and IT leadership, translating complex AI and cloud solution capabilities into clear architectural recommendations and actionable implementation roadmaps.
- Developed and delivered AI/Copilot solution demonstrations and technical enablement sessions for enterprise stakeholders, bridging the gap between product capability and customer business requirements to accelerate deal cycles.

SHI, Austin, Texas - July 2021 – June 2022

Commercial Account Executive

- Applied deep technical knowledge of Microsoft, VMware, and Cisco solution stacks to support contract negotiations, improving renewal rates by 90+ percentage points while generating a 30% uplift in recurring revenue.
- Strengthened vendor alliances that contributed to over \$500K in new solution-based revenue and a 3x increase in joint account pipeline opportunities.

SHI, Somerset, New Jersey - March 2018 – July 2021

Enterprise Field Solutions Engineer

- Delivered data center modernization initiatives that increased client system uptime and contributed \$2M+ in new solution revenue.
- Guided technology investment decisions for 40+ enterprises and SLED accounts across LA, MS, and FL, influencing over \$15M in annual IT spend.
- Collaborated with vendor engineering teams to capture detailed requirements, increasing solution win rates by over 30% while improving solution accuracy for services opportunities.
- Coordinated with channel partner SE teams on joint technical pursuits, developing co-sell solution architectures that generated \$1.5M+ in partner pipeline and strengthened multi-vendor solution positioning.
- Provided technical mentorship and field enablement to junior SEs and partner engineers, building team capability around multi-vendor solution portfolios to improve deal quality and win rates.

Microsoft, Redmond, Washington - April 2014 – March 2018

Enterprise Technical Account Manager

- Designed and delivered post-deployment technical enablement programs for enterprise customers, ensuring successful adoption of Microsoft cloud solutions and reducing time-to-productivity through structured knowledge transfer.
- Provided solution architecture guidance on SharePoint and OneDrive deployments, advising enterprise IT teams on configuration best practices, governance models, and integration patterns to maximize platform value.
- Owned technical relationships across a \$2M+ enterprise account portfolio, delivering 15%+ YoY growth by aligning solution architecture to customer business objectives and ensuring successful deployment of Cloud and Premier Support services.
- Led technical pursuit strategy for net-new enterprise accounts, developing tailored solution architectures and competitive differentiators that secured two new logos in underserved market segments.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- As the senior technical lead and technical project manager, led a large-scale integration of Citrix and Epic EMR at Ochsner Health, increasing system adoption to over 90% and accelerating clinical application deployment. Improved clinician workflows and reduced patient record access time by 30%.
- Spearheaded multi-year strategic planning for an Academic Medical Center IT transformation, overseeing enablement, consumption, and cost optimization resulting in improved system uptime and enhanced budget forecasting, driving reliable healthcare operations and long-term IT investment sustainability.
- Led a large-scale telco Office 365 migration through strategic discovery, workshops, and training that migrated 75,000+ licensed seats and standardized collaboration through SharePoint, Teams, and OneDrive, improving operational efficiency and user engagement.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Associate of Applied Science, Computer Network and Security Technology – 2007

Herzing College, Kenner, LA

Certifications:

- ITIL Foundations
- Microsoft: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)
- Microsoft: Azure AI Fundamentals (AI-900)
- Rubrik Technical Professional (RTP)
- Cohesity SE Professional
- Veeam Sales Professional (VMSP)
- Epic Certified Systems Manager (ECSM)